

Chapter 38-2: Embrace

After the Chaotic Realm stabilized, Chu Qingqiu's pale lips pressed together slightly. She suddenly summoned White Bone, and the white jade staff transformed into a giant pillar, carrying brilliant white light as it stabbed toward the sky that had become colorless.

Like piercing into the sea surface, the sky rippled outward. Though small, it still opened a door to the outside world.

"We're saved! We're saved!" Someone in the crowd was crying and praying.

At the same time, chaos also erupted outside the realm. Dozens of sect leaders and elders who were also trying to open the Chaotic Realm stood in mid-air. Seeing the sky that had shown no movement finally reveal an arc, they excitedly opened their eyes wide.

"Sect Leader Tang, it's Chu Ling Divine Venerable!" Master Feiguang¹ of Kongming Sect nearly shed tears. He vigorously shook the staff in his hand, working even harder to tear at the crack that had finally appeared in the sky.

"Yes." Blue veins appeared on Tang Wenshu's² usually gentle and refined face. "Everyone, put in more effort!"

Inside and outside the realm, there was brilliant light everywhere. Such powerful force alarmed the four azure phoenixes guarding the divine mountain, their mournful cries echoing through heaven and earth.

Finally, light spots appeared on several disciples' bodies, then they transformed into points of light, flowing like meteors out of the Chaotic Realm and appearing on Zhaoyang Peak.

Then more and more people left the Chaotic Realm. Fewer and fewer remained inside, until only scattered individuals were left.

Yet Chu Qingqiu still stood in mid-air. Her hair, which was never disturbed by wind, was finally somewhat disheveled. As others left, the light within the Chaotic Realm gradually dimmed. In the end, only her immortal power was holding it up. The fierce fire burned again, from thousands of li to hundreds of li, until finally only dozens of li of space remained around them.

The last to remain were disciples from Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate. They supported each other, their bodies gradually being covered by light spots as they left one by one.

"Go quickly!" Hong Ying and Feng Ge urged the other disciples, then looked at Ning Fuyi, Rong Jin, and Liu Wenzhu, their gazes flickering for a moment. "You three, why haven't you left yet?"

"We're coming right away!" Liu Wenzhu quickly said, then pulled Ning Fuyi's arm. Immediately, light spots covered them.

Ning Fuyi felt the warmth of the light points and suddenly turned to look at Chu Qingqiu, only to see her still standing in mid-air, simultaneously supporting the exit door and preventing the Chaotic Realm's destruction.

But she was obviously exhausted. The speed of the Chaotic Realm's disappearance accelerated again. Before long, only fragments of earth remained beneath their feet.

If one looked carefully, one could see traces of blood seeping from her pale lips.

"Ning Fuyi! What are you still standing there for? The Divine Venerable will be fine!" Rong Jin said while simply pulling her toward the circular door.

However, just as Ning Fuyi's body was about to pass through the door, her arm suddenly bent at a strange angle, allowing her to escape from his grasp. She pushed the two of them out while turning around and soaring toward Chu Qingqiu.

She saw Chu Qingqiu's usually calm expression finally crack. She seemed to be saying something sternly, followed by a ringing sound like tinnitus.

Then the world fell silent.

Patter, patter.

The deafening sound of dripping water echoed in her ears one drop at a time. Ning Fuyi blinked and suddenly sat up.

Where she had been lying was accumulating water. Water drops kept falling from above, creating the dripping sound.

The ground was slippery, and several night-luminous pearls seemed to be embedded in the walls, emitting weak light that made the surroundings less dim. Ning Fuyi got up from the ground and patted her torn dress.

She seemed to be in a huge stone chamber. On the left was a pool several zhang³ in circumference, but the pool was now dried up. However, she could see five-colored gemstones embedded at the bottom, showing the former beauty of this place.

She had been to this place before. Ning Fuyi knew with just one glance - this was Shenyu.

The Emei Thorn was here. Ning Fuyi felt a surge of excitement, but then became nervous again, softly calling: "Divine Venerable?"

"Chu Qingqiu?"

There was movement from a corner of the stone chamber. Ning Fuyi quickly ran over and moved aside two stones, revealing a pair of dust-covered hands. Her heart tightened as she waved her hand to push away the remaining stones.

Chu Qingqiu was lying on the ground, her exposed skin covered with small wounds. Only her face was relatively clean, though blood stained the corners of her lips.

"Chu Qingqiu!" Ning Fuyi tried hard to pull her up, but was suddenly pushed away by her as she moved.

"What are you shouting about? I'm not dead." Chu Qingqiu said in a low voice. She slowly sat up, her wrist turning to grasp White Bone, about to hit Ning Fuyi's head with it. Fortunately, Ning Fuyi was quick-eyed and nimble, her body suddenly retreating to dodge the blow.

"I kindly saved you, what are you doing?" Ning Fuyi looked at the menacing White Bone with lingering fear.

"I held on for so long just to let you all escape, but you turned around to seek death. If you really don't want to live, I'll fulfill your wish!" Chu Qingqiu's pale face flushed with anger. She raised her hand to hit Ning Fuyi's head again, but suddenly began coughing violently, having no choice but to use White Bone to support her body.

Seeing blood staining those soft lips, Ning Fuyi quickly waved her hand and scattered countless beast stones from her One-Thought Pearl, helplessly showing them to Chu Qingqiu.

Seeing the glittering beast stones displayed before her, Chu Qingqiu's anger subsided somewhat, and her coughing also lessened.

"The Zhaoyang Saintess set the rule that the most beast stones can open Shenyu." Ning Fuyi said. "If I hadn't come to save you, did you want to die alone in the Chaotic Realm?"

"Besides, I was the one who called you there. Though I'm not exactly a good person, I'm not a villain either." Ning Fuyi casually tossed those beast stones aside, muttering.

Chu Qingqiu's hand gripping White Bone tightened, and she looked away: "I wouldn't have died."

"Alright, you're powerful." Ning Fuyi said as she stood up. However, after walking two steps and turning back, she found Chu Qingqiu still sitting in the same place, not moving.

So she turned back again, crouched in front of her, and reached out to support Chu Qingqiu's shoulder. But Chu Qingqiu dodged, revealing a large bloodstain on her abdomen.

The shocking red made Ning Fuyi freeze immediately. Only now did she realize the other person had been enduring all along. With such a severe wound, she hadn't made a sound.

"You're injured?" Ning Fuyi frowned. She couldn't see the wound clearly, but she could see wisps of demonic qi drifting from the wound.

Had demons followed them? Ning Fuyi's gaze suddenly turned cold. Whatever could injure Chu Qingqiu to this extent was definitely not an ordinary demon.

Chu Qingqiu hummed in acknowledgment, then said it was nothing and struggled to stand up, supporting herself with White Bone.

Her soft white hands were trembling, and her whole person was like a lotus in wind and rain, her body shrouded in loose robes. Usually, because of her power, one didn't notice, but now one could see how slender she really was.

Ning Fuyi felt a strange sensation in her heart, as if she was trembling along with her.

Ning Fuyi watched for a while, then suddenly stepped forward, her left hand passing through Chu Qingqiu's shoulder, her right hand against her knees.

With effort, she actually lifted Chu Qingqiu horizontally into her arms.

Footnotes:

1. **Master Feiguang (飞光禅师)** - "Flying Light Zen Master," the leader of Kongming Sect (Empty Brightness Sect)
2. **Tang Wenshu (唐温书)** - The sect leader of Tianji Sword Sect
3. **Zhang (丈)** - An ancient Chinese unit of measurement, approximately 3.33 meters or about 11 feet